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JGME Reviewer Summary

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This document explains two Journal of Graduate Medical Education (JGME) review outcomes in plain language. In both cases, the manuscripts were **not selected for publication**, and the notes below explain what Reviewer #1 (aka me, Matt) contributed and what the journal ultimately decided.

What this document is for

This summary is meant for a non-technical reader. It explains, in simple terms, what the papers were about, what concerns were raised in review, and what the final publication outcome was.[1][2]

Manuscript 1: Generative Artificial Intelligence Use in Pediatric Residency Personal Statements

Manuscript ID: JGME-D-26-00298.[1]

Topic in plain language: This paper studied whether pediatric residency applicants may have used generative AI in their personal statements, and whether commercial AI-detection tools could measure that use reliably.[1]

Reviewer role: Reviewer #1 provided detailed general and specific comments to the authors.[1]

Main concerns raised: - The paper relied heavily on AI-detection tools whose accuracy and reliability were questioned, especially for high-stakes decisions like residency review.[1] - The manuscript did not adequately address the broader real-world AI ecosystem already affecting residency applications, including AAMC/Thalamus Cortex and common applicant-facing tools such as Microsoft Copilot.[1] - Important factual and methodological issues were identified, including the use of “AI” and “ChatGPT” as if they were interchangeable, an incorrect GPT-4 release date, weak justification for tool selection, and problems with how “any AI detection” was treated analytically.[1] - The review emphasized that baseline false positives in pre-ChatGPT 2022 essays made later comparisons difficult to interpret without stronger thresholding or sensitivity analyses.[1]

What the journal decided: The editor decided **not to publish** the paper.[1]

Why that makes sense to a non-technical reader: The study asked an important question, but the review record shows major doubts about whether the measurement tools were trustworthy enough to support the paper’s conclusions. When a paper’s core measurement method is shaky, the journal may decline publication even if the topic itself is timely.[1]

Manuscript 2: Algorithmic Scheduling to Improve Resident Well-Being and Equity in Call Distribution

Manuscript ID: JGME-D-25-01151.[2]

Topic in plain language: This paper described a residency scheduling approach that used open-source optimization software to make call schedules more fair and less time-consuming to build.[2]

Reviewer role: Reviewer #1 provided both general comments and numbered specific comments for the authors

Main concerns raised: - The review praised the use of open-source tools and transparent optimization logic instead of expensive or opaque commercial systems, calling that choice a strength. - At the same time, the review argued that the manuscript overstated its contribution by saying the authors had “developed” scheduling software when they had actually implemented an existing solver, Google OR-Tools CP-SAT, for a new use case. - The review requested much more reproducibility detail, including software versions, Python version, installation method, hardware or operating environment, exact constraint weights, and mathematical formulation.[2] - Additional concerns focused on unclear metrics, inconsistent terminology, overstatement of statistical significance, limited discussion of trade-offs, and a conclusion that went beyond what the reported data actually demonstrated.

What the journal decided: The editor decided **not to publish** the paper.

What “Reviewer #1” means here

In academic publishing, reviewers are outside experts asked to evaluate whether a manuscript is accurate, clear, useful, and strong enough for publication. Reviewer #1 is simply one anonymous reviewer label used by the journal during peer review.[1][2]

In these two cases, Reviewer #1 contributed substantive written feedback that focused on whether the manuscripts were methodologically sound, transparent, and appropriately framed for the journal’s audience.[1][2]

What “not published” means

“Not published” means the journal chose not to accept the manuscript for publication in JGME. It does **not** automatically mean the work was worthless or fraudulent; it means the editors concluded the paper was not a fit for publication in its current form, whether because of space limits, methodological weaknesses, framing problems, or some combination of those factors.

In both decision letters, the journal explicitly said the papers addressed important topics, but the final editorial decision was still not to publish them.

Plain-language takeaway

Across both manuscripts, Reviewer #1's role was to push for stronger evidence, clearer methods, and claims that matched the actual data. In both cases, the journal ultimately declined publication, which is consistent with a review process that found the topics worthwhile but the manuscripts not yet strong enough for acceptance.